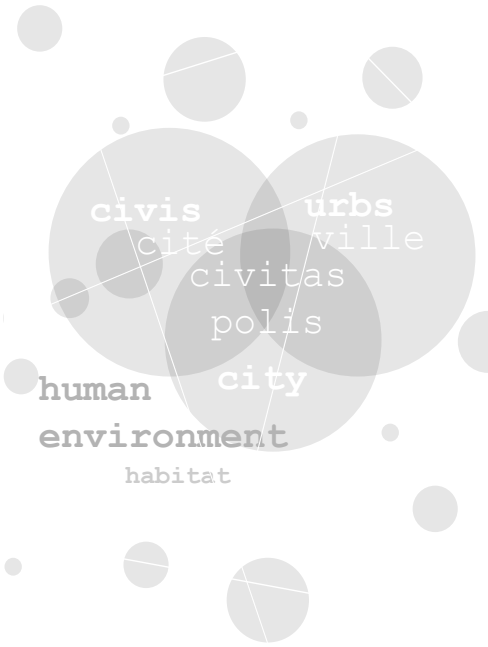
Human Environment.



Field declaration for [Urban] Design City

The **Human Environment** is the field in which urban conditions take form. It brings into relation spatial, social, infrastructural, and institutional dimensions that are often treated separately, resulting in partial alignment within the city.

This field defines the relation between human existence and spatial systems as a single, structured condition. Within it, urban design operates through spatial articulation, structuring relations between actors, spaces, and institutions and translating questions of governance, accessibility, and transformation into concrete situations.

It examines human, environment, and their modes of interaction as distinct yet interdependent dimensions, with the aim of rendering this field explicit and operable as a basis for inquiry and design.

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A fragmented field

Urban design engages spatial, social, infrastructural, and institutional domains that frequently evolve through separate frameworks. Spatial configuration, governance structures, infrastructural systems, and collective practices often develop in parallel, producing only partial alignment within urban environments.

This fragmentation underscores the need for a shared structure capable of holding these domains within a coherent field of inquiry.

The city as condition

Architecture contributes to the construction of environments that support human life. Cities are the environments humans construct in order to live together: spatial conditions where social, economic, political, and cultural functions intersect.

This condition extends beyond built form. The city operates as the *habitat* of collective life, where spatial configurations and human practices remain closely intertwined. Human existence unfolds within these configurations, both as individual experience and as shared condition.

A relational structure

At the core of the city lies the relation between human existence and spatial systems. This relation takes shape across perception, use, and governance, linking architectural space with urban and infrastructural structures.

The city can be understood through three interdependent dimensions:
• *urbs* — the physical configuration of space
• *civitas* — the collective life of its inhabitants
• *polis* — the political structures that organise coexistence

Together, these dimensions describe the conditions through which urban life takes form.
Within this articulation, the city emerges as a relational condition in which human existence and spatial systems are continuously produced through interaction.
This condition is defined as the **Human Environment**.

Beyond the built

The **Human Environment** extends the notion of the built environment by situating it within a broader structure that includes collective life and political organisation.
The spatial dimension remains central, but it operates as part of a wider relational condition in which spatial, social, and institutional dimensions are continuously intertwined.

An operative field

The **Human Environment** describes a structure in which human existence — individual, social, and political — and spatial systems — architectural, urban, and infrastructural — develop in continuous relation.
Each dimension takes shape through interaction with the others.

Within this field:
- spatial form operates as a configuration of relations
- institutional structures take form through spatial arrangements that organise collective life
- infrastructure redistributes access, exposure, and capacity
- human action unfolds within these configurations and contributes to their ongoing transformation

Urban design as practice

Urban design operates within this condition through spatial articulation.
It structures relations between actors, spaces, and institutions, bringing questions of governance, accessibility, equity, and transformation into concrete and situated form.
Establishing the **Human Environment** as an operative field clarifies the terrain on which these interventions take place. It frames relations across domains while maintaining their specificity and interdependence.

The notebooks that follow decompose this field into its constitutive dimensions — human, environment, and their modes of interaction — examining how each operates independently and in relation to the others.

The objective is to render this structure explicit and operable.

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